RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

20 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 5:46 PM, Tuesday 20 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 249 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 52 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 12,750 minutes at 6:00 PM (only movement since 3 PM: Sky Vision Airlines 0S2828 to Milan at 5:36 PM); Dammam moving with no open halt

1

INCIDENT SUMMARY

What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 12,750 minutes at 6:00 PM; only one takeoff since 3 PM (Sky Vision Airlines 0S2828 to Milan, 5:36 PM) and no landings**.
- 249 Tuesday Riyadh flights cancelled (42%), and NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight.
- Coalition says a drone was intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh region at 5:22 PM, the second Riyadh-area intercept today; no damage reported.
- Saudi Cabinet welcomes the UN Security Council condemnation of Houthi attacks on airports and energy sites; UK sends RAF Typhoons for defensive patrols.
- Dammam airport moving with no open halt: 9 takeoffs and 7 landings since 3 PM, latest flynas XY420 from Jeddah at 5:24 PM.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (12737 min).

249 CANCELLED TODAY · **1/0** TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H · **7** DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

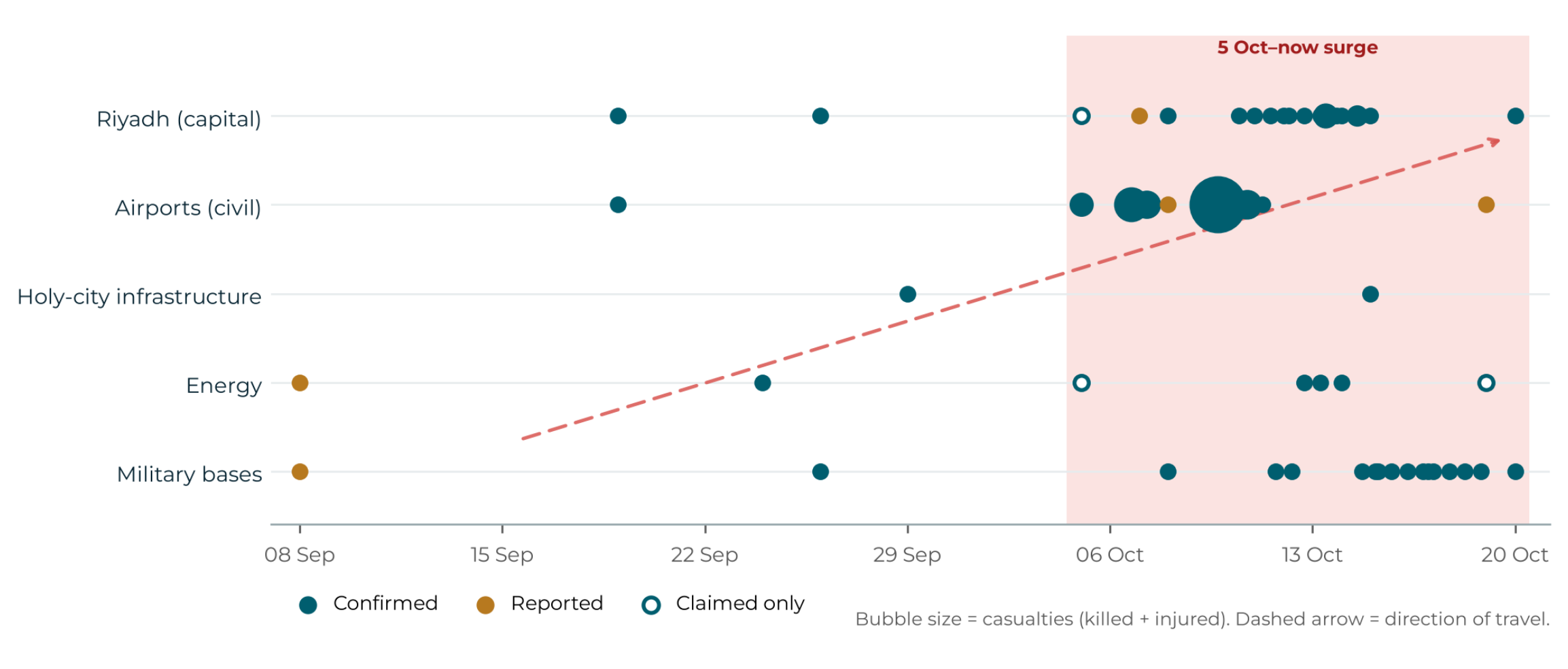
1 takeoff and 2 landings in the last hour.

52 CANCELLED TODAY · **1/2** TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H · **0** DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (12,750 min at 6:00 PM); one takeoff since 3 PM (Sky Vision Airlines 0S2828 to Milan, 5:36 PM), no landings
- Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh region at 5:22 PM; no damage or casualties reported
- Saudi Cabinet welcomed the UN Security Council condemnation of Houthi attacks on airports and energy sites
- UK to fly RAF Typhoon defensive patrols over Saudi cities and infrastructure
- Dammam moving, no halt since 8:11 AM: 9 takeoffs and 7 landings since 3 PM, latest XY420 from Jeddah at 5:24 PM

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 20 OCT



54 sourced events since 8 September (46 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh region (20 Oct, Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA; none reported). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

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ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 3:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED INTERCEPTION **5:22 PM AST · Riyadh**

Drone intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh region. Coalition spokesman / SPA · none reported

Last 24 hours: Attacks 3, interceptions 3, alerts 1, all-clears 1.

3

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

Drone intercepted over the Riyadh region at 5:22 PM; Cabinet welcomes UN condemnation; UK sends Typhoons; Riyadh airport still halted

Checked at 5:55 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh region**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox); SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **5:22 PM** · published 5:22 PM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); SPA Arabic 5:24 PM, SPA English 5:31 PM, Al Ekhbariya 5:25 PM; checked 5:55 PM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki said a drone was intercepted and destroyed in the Riyadh region. It is the second Riyadh-area intercept today after the 11:39 AM ballistic missile. No debris, damage or casualties have been reported, and no Civil Defense alert for it appeared on the official account.

CORROBORATED **Reuters: most Gulf stock markets slip after new Houthi claims against Saudi energy and airport sites**

Reuters (@Reuters) · **4:10 PM** · posted 4:10 PM AST Tue 20 Oct; checked 5:55 PM; the Houthi claims themselves are not confirmed by Saudi authorities

Reuters reported that most Gulf bourses retreated on Tuesday after the Houthis claimed operations against Saudi energy and airport sites. Saudi authorities have not confirmed those claims.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Cabinet welcomes the UN Security Council condemnation of Houthi attacks on airports and energy sites**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv); SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **3:19 PM** · published 3:19 PM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); SPA English 3:30 PM; Al Arabiya English 4:19 PM; checked 5:55 PM

At the weekly session chaired by King Salman in Riyadh, the Cabinet welcomed the Security Council's condemnation of Houthi attacks on civilian sites, airports and energy infrastructure in the Kingdom and of the continuing threats to shipping in the Red Sea and Bab el-Mandeb. The statement did not mention any change to Riyadh airport operations.

CORROBORATED **Reuters: airlines keep cancelling Saudi flights; Air France-KLM to 7 Nov, Lufthansa to 18 Nov, Delta's Riyadh launch moved to March 2027**

Reuters factbox (via Investing.com); Semafor; Gulf Business · **3:14 PM** · Semafor summary of the Reuters report 3:14 PM AST (8:14 AM EDT) Tue 20 Oct; Gulf Business 1:53 PM; checked 5:55 PM

Reuters says Riyadh airport reopened at the weekend but every departure and landing needs GACA permission. Air France-KLM extended its Riyadh suspension to 7 November, Lufthansa Group to 18 November, Philippine Airlines to 29 November and Cathay Pacific to 31 January 2027, while Delta pushed its Atlanta to Riyadh launch to March 2027 and Gulf Air flights remained suspended.

CONFIRMED **UK to fly RAF Typhoon defensive patrols to protect Saudi cities and infrastructure from Houthi attacks**

UK Ministry of Defence (GOV.UK); AP, BBC, The National · **1:59 PM** · GOV.UK operational update published 1:59 PM AST (10:59 UTC) Tue 20 Oct; BBC 2:09 PM, AP updated 4:32 PM; checked 5:55 PM

Defence Secretary Wes Streeting approved RAF Typhoon jets for defensive counter-air missions to intercept Houthi missiles and drones over Saudi Arabia; the UK says they will not strike targets in Yemen. The package adds an A400M Atlas transport aircraft and military advisers, and extends existing air-to-air refuelling support.

CORROBORATED **AFP: two blasts heard in Riyadh as the Houthi missile was intercepted; Ministry of Defense confirms**

AFP; SPA (Ministry of Defense) · **12:47 PM** · AFP story published 12:47 PM AST Tue 20 Oct (Dhaka Tribune, Gulf Times); SPA Ministry of Defense statement; checked 2:50 PM

AFP journalists in the capital reported two blasts after the 11:11 AM Civil Defense warning. The Ministry of Defense said through SPA that Royal Saudi Air Defense intercepted and destroyed the ballistic missile launched toward Riyadh. No damage or casualties have been reported.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: Houthi ballistic missile fired toward Riyadh intercepted and destroyed**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **11:39 AM** · published 11:39 AM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); SPA and Al Ekhbariya 11:41 AM; checked 11:58 AM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki said a ballistic missile launched by the Houthis toward Riyadh was intercepted and destroyed. No debris, damage or casualties have been reported so far. Al Jazeera, Al Arabiya and AFP-relayed outlets carried the statement within minutes.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Civil Defense: early-warning alert for Riyadh City at 11:11 AM, all-clear at 11:17 AM**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **11:11 AM** · alert 11:11 AM, all-clear 11:17 AM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account); Al Ekhbariya relayed both; checked 11:58 AM

Civil Defense issued a warning through the National Early Warning Platform for Riyadh City, then said the danger had passed six minutes later. It again warned that filming or sharing information about interceptions or impact sites exposes people to legal liability.

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KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (12737 min).

249
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY
118 departures + 131 arrivals, 42% of 593 scheduled.

5:36 PM
LAST TAKEOFF
0S2828 to Milan, 10 min before 5:46 PM.

8:43 PM
LAST LANDING
N437GA from Athens, 1263 min before 5:46 PM.

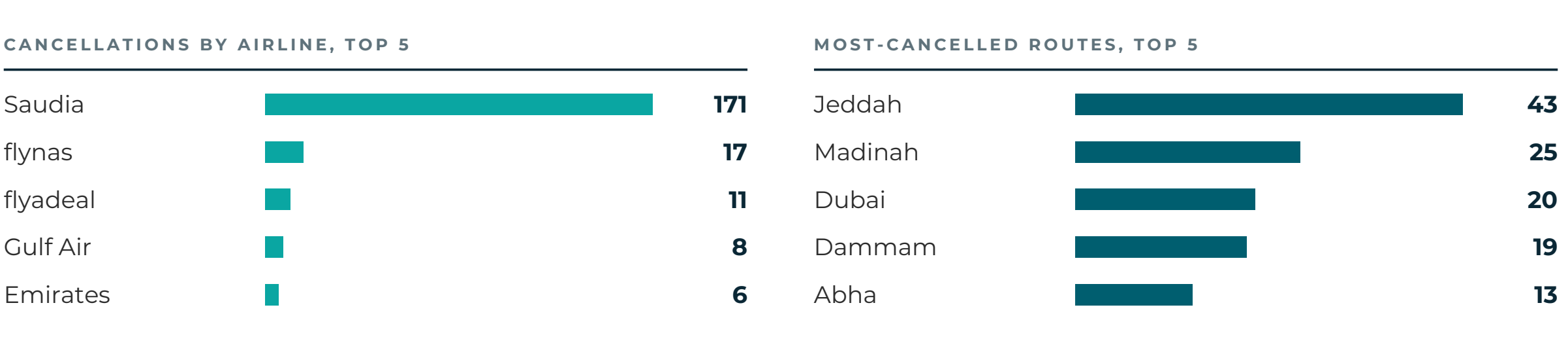
1
TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR
0 landings in the last hour.

7
ARRIVALS DIVERTED
Mostly to Jeddah, Dammam.

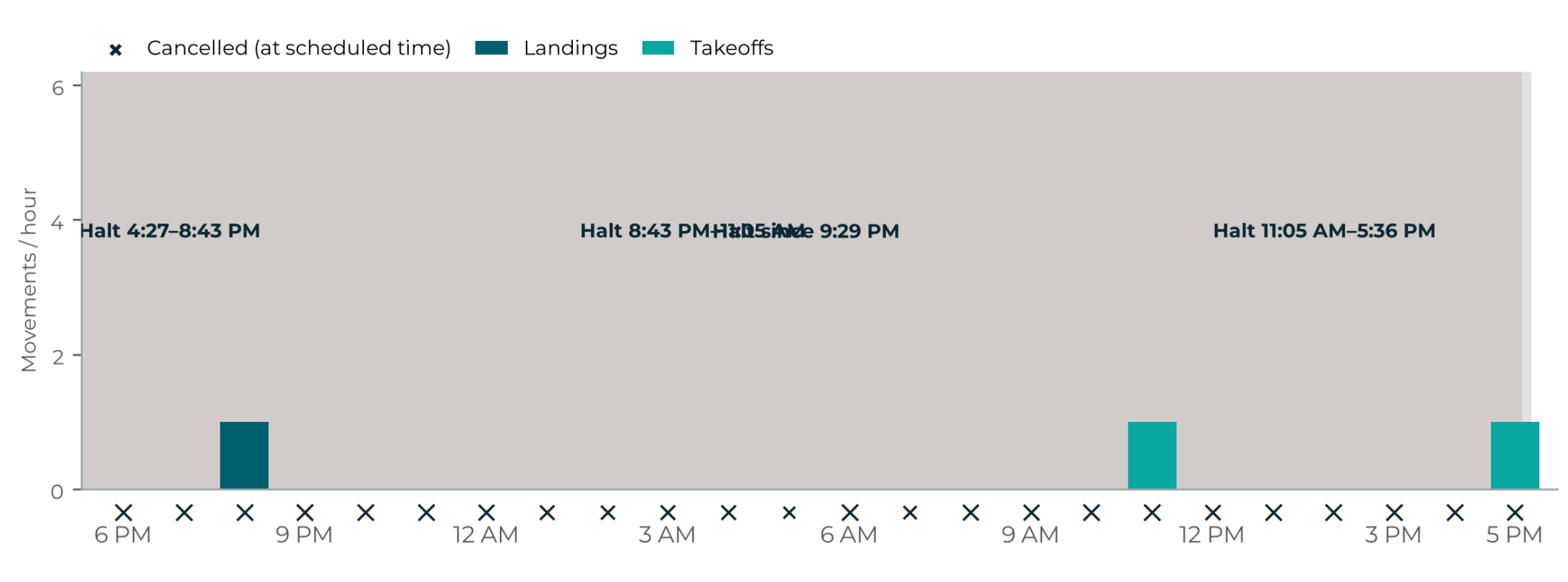
***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 5:46 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 230 at 5:46 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	118	131	249	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	108 (36%)	122 (41%)	230	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	3 (1%)	1 (0%)	4	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	3 (50%)	3 (75%)	6	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	45 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	2 of 222	0 of 188	2 of 410	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	7	7	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	21	24	45	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	72	100	172	FR24 stats panel



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



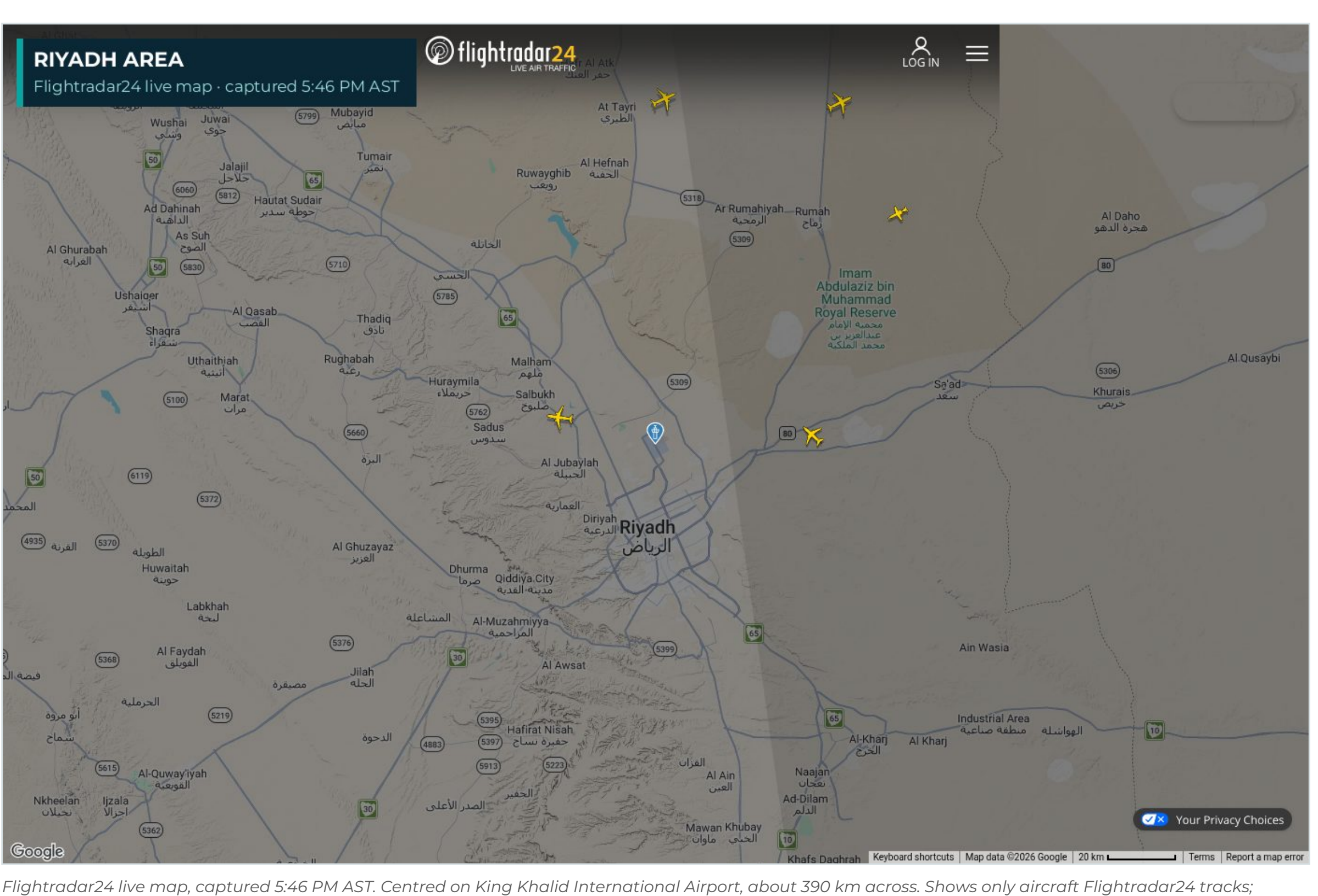
Recorded takeoffs (2) and landings (1) at RUH per hour from 6:00 PM Monday to 5:46 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are non-scheduled flights: landings SV918 at 4:27 PM and N437GA at 8:43 PM Monday, and the private-jet takeoff HZSK5 to Geneva at 11:05 AM Tuesday. Dammam's halts in the window ran 12:41–1:48 AM, 2:04–2:53 AM, 5:15–6:17 AM and 7:13–8:11 AM Tuesday; Dammam has had no halt since 8:11 AM; its longest gap since 12:00 PM was 17 minutes.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 11:05 AM–5:36 PM	391 min
Halt 8:43 PM–11:05 AM	862 min
Halt 4:27–8:43 PM	256 min
OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	12737 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 5:46 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

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KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

Dammam airport: disrupted. 1 takeoff and 2 landings in the last hour.

52
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY
25 departures + 27 arrivals, 24% of 220 scheduled.

4:55 PM
LAST TAKEOFF
XY711 to Taif, 51 min before 5:46 PM.

5:24 PM
LAST LANDING
XY420 from Jeddah, 21 min before 5:46 PM.

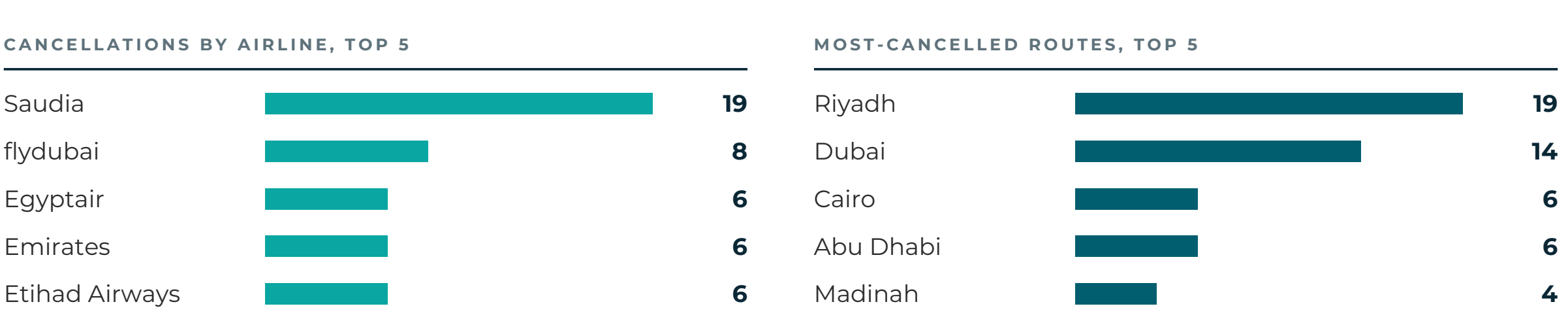
1
TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR
2 landings in the last hour.

0
ARRIVALS DIVERTED
None recorded today.

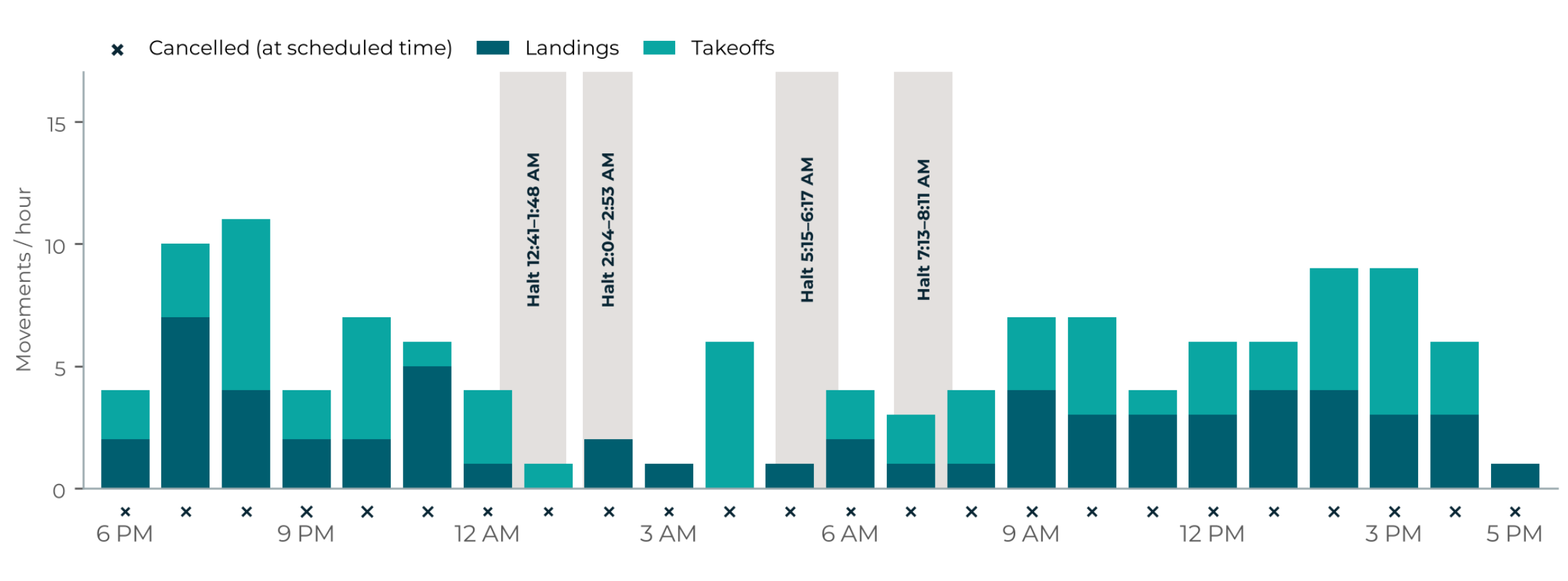
***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 5:46 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 49 at 5:46 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	25	27	52	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	24 (21%)	25 (23%)	49	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	20 (18%)	10 (9%)	30	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	27 (57%)	27 (73%)	54	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	6 min	5 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	44 of 79	37 of 72	81 of 151	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	13	14	27	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	15	18	33	FR24 stats panel



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (64) and landings (59) at DMM per hour from 6:00 PM Monday to 5:46 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Moving, no open halt at 6:00 PM: 1 takeoff and 2 landings in the last hour; 9 takeoffs and 7 landings since 3 PM; no new halt since the last edition.

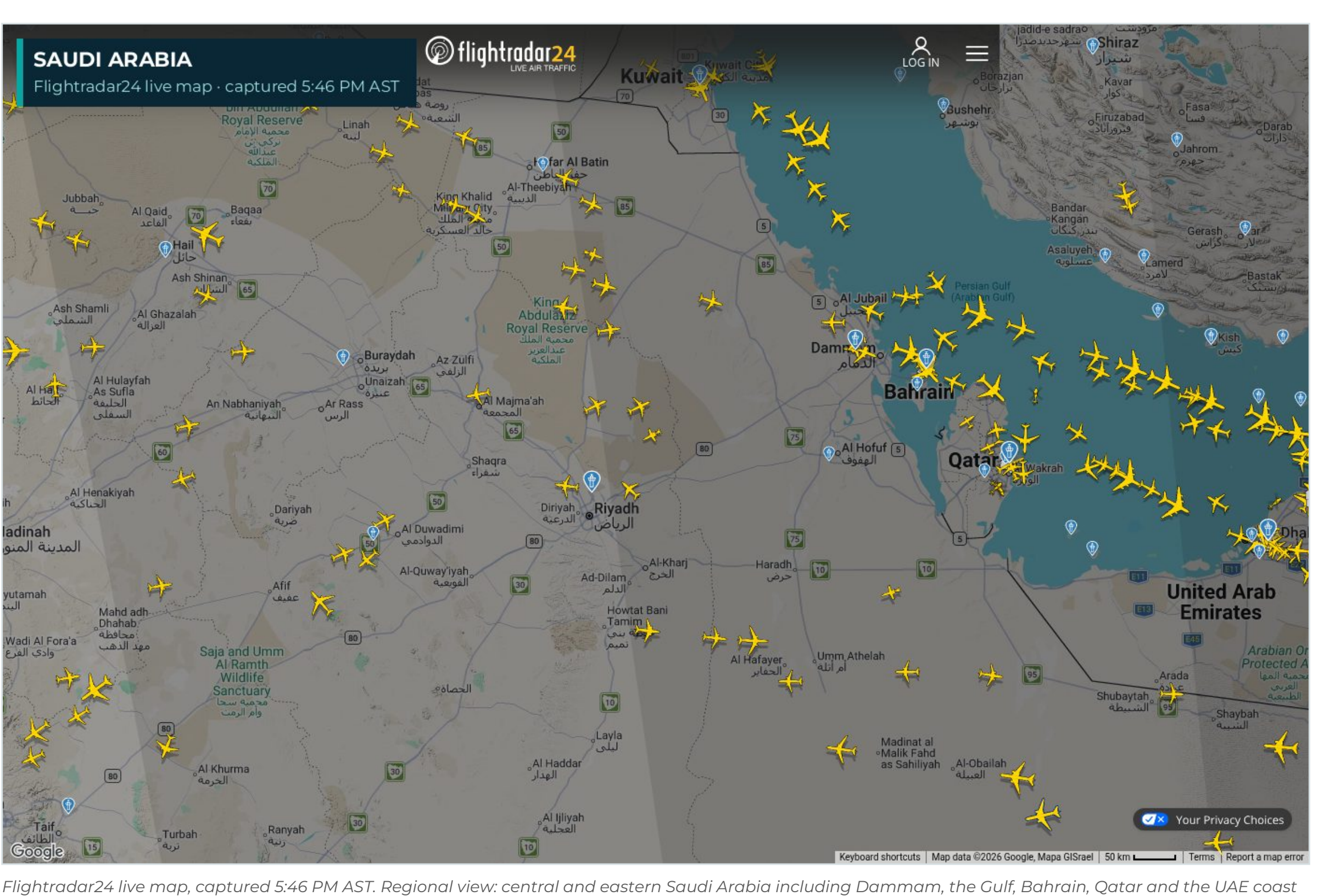
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 7:13–8:11 AM	58 min
Halt 5:15–6:17 AM	62 min
Halt 2:04–2:53 AM	49 min
Halt 12:41–1:48 AM	66 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (5:55 PM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 5:46 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

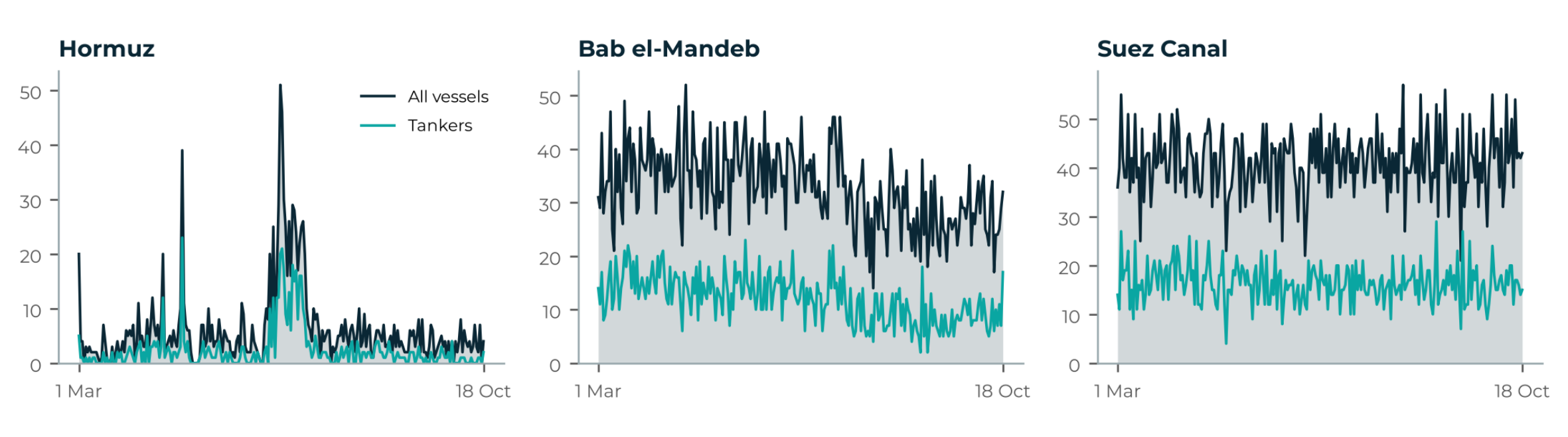
6

ECONOMY

Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

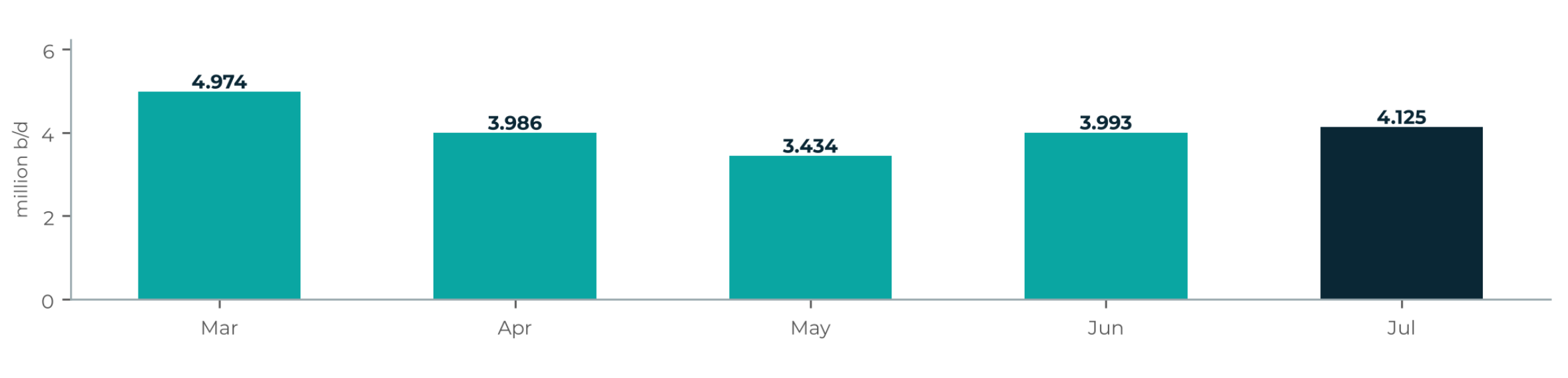
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 18 Oct	**4**	2	2	3.7 (4.1)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 18 Oct	**32**	17	15	26.4 (28.3)
Suez Canal	Sun 18 Oct	**43**	15	28	44.3 (41.7)



Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. ***Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.*** *Fetched 5:47 PM, Tue 20 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)



Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

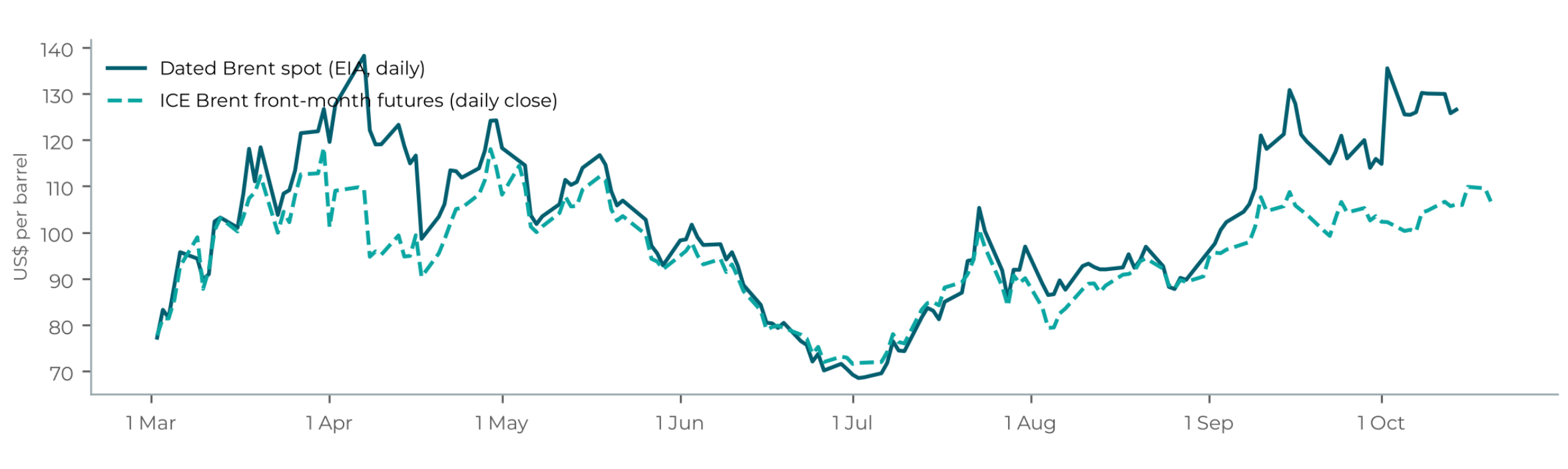
BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$106.70
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST
ICE front-month, 5:37 PM, Tue 20 Oct AST (-2.6% on day). Near real time.

$126.55
DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)
Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.

+4%
SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE
From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.

+64%
SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

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METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 5:46 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
5:46 PM, Tue 20 Oct	5:46 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	9:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 9:00 PM